HOME GROWN PLAYERS

The MOTN findings on the best chief ministers show that parties cannot underestimate **the importance of having powerful satraps in the states**

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1 NAVEEN PATNAIK, *Odisha* **78%** [71%]

MOST POPULAR CM (in home state)

Respondents in every state were asked to rate their chief minister

	Aug. 2022	Jan. 2022
2. Himanta Biswa Sarma *(Assam)*	63	57
3. M.K. Stalin *(Tamil Nadu)*	61	68
4. Arvind Kejriwal *(Delhi)*	59	58
5. Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy *(Andhra Pradesh)*	57	40
6. Pushkar Dhami *(Uttarakhand)*	55	33
7. Bhupesh Baghel *(Chhattisgarh)*	53	51
8. Conrad K. Sangma *(Meghalaya)*	49	41
9. Shivraj Singh Chouhan *(Madhya Pradesh)*	43	40
10. Basavaraj Bommai *(Karnataka)*	43	33

(All figures in percentage)

Note: Respondents of every state were asked to evaluate the performance of their own CM. For instance, 78.1 per cent of the 4,564 respondents in Odisha said they were satisfied with Naveen Patnaik's performance; 63.4 per cent of 4,227 respondents in Assam gave a thumbs up to Himanta Biswa Sarma

In an age of 24x7 media scrutiny, the chief minister's job is undoubtedly one of the toughest in India. The Constitution vests the position with immense powers but with it also comes accountability. In the past decade, assembly polls have increasingly been fought on the persona and performance of chief ministers. The Prime Minister Narendra Modi-led BJP may be a dominant force in the Lok Sabha election but in several state elections where it went up against a strong chief ministerial face, it has stumbled. Some glaring examples are West Bengal, Odisha and Delhi.

Even the Congress, which has performed abysmally in the past two Lok Sabha elections, has been able to best the BJP wherever it has found a strong regional leader, as was seen in Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh in 2018. So it's clear—political parties must nurture strong regional leaders not just to win elections in the home state but also to showcase a model of ideal governance nationally. PM Modi had fought the 2014 general election on the 'Gujarat model' plank he developed as chief minister of the state.

One chief minister who has consistently earned high ratings from his voters is Naveen Patnaik. Away from the din of national politics, the longest-serving chief minister of Odisha has remained unchallenged in his home state for two decades. The MOTN poll shows that 78 per cent respondents in Odisha expressed satisfaction at his performance, up from 71 per cent six months ago. This makes